

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 427

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor the Tennessee Department of Transportation on winning the 2024 Southeast Rodeo.

WHEREAS, the Tennessee Department of Transportation (TDOT) team has won the 2024 Southeast Rodeo, thus claiming its tenth championship out of the seventeen Rodeos held since 2006; and

WHEREAS, the Southeast Rodeo features leading equipment operators from eleven states, who compete against each other on a course designed to test their skills in operating the following equipment: backhoe, single axle dump truck, tandem axle dump truck, skid steer, lowboy, tractor mower, and motor grader; and

WHEREAS, focusing on efficiency and skill, the Southeast Rodeo provides operators with the opportunity to display their mastery of vehicles, trailers, and heavy equipment; evaluate their strengths and challenges; improve their techniques; and learn new skills, while engaging in friendly competition; and

WHEREAS, the Rodeo also helps build relationships and trust among operators; these relationships are invaluable when operators from across the State come together to work as a team during emergency conditions and disaster-related situations; and

WHEREAS, the TDOT team won the State's tenth Southeast Rodeo by taking first and second place in the skid steer category and first and second place in the single axle dump truck competition; and

WHEREAS, the members of TDOT's 2024 Southeast Rodeo championship team are Benjamin Bolden and Josh Human representing Region 1; David Bragg, Dewayne Everett, Ricky Moss, and Ronnie Spivey representing Region 2; Evan Mitchell, Joel Bates, Mike Puckett,

John Young, and Richard Sullins representing Region 3; and Clint Bowman, Hunter Butler, and Logan Garner representing Region 4; and

WHEREAS, their victory reaffirms our high opinion of TDOT and its dedicated employees, who are most deserving of our approbation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the Tennessee Department of Transportation team on winning the 2024 Southeast Roadeo, applaud its members' ongoing commitment to making Tennessee's roads and highways the best in the nation, and extend to them our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.